NATIONAL GOVERNMENT CONSTITUENCIES DEVELOPMENT FUND
Maendeleo kwa Wote · Field Activity Planning and Monitoring

FAPM: Your First Activity, Start to Finish

Practice and testing guide, revised 25 October 2026

RESTRICTED

This guide takes one practice activity from the first click to the last, the way activities now flow. A Head of Department prepares the memo and its team, the Office of the CEO reviews it, and the CEO approves it. The CEO then instructs Finance to process the imprest and Procurement to buy the tickets. You follow the activity in the field, the department submits its report with what was spent, and the Office of the CEO accepts it and closes the activity. It takes about 90 minutes. Do every part in order and you will have tested every main flow in the system.

> **Use the test system, never the live one.** Nothing in FAPM can be deleted once it is submitted, so a practice activity on the live system would stay there for good. Your trainer will give you the test system's web address.

What is new since the 11 October edition. Heads of Department now prepare memos and build their own team and costs (Parts 4 to 6). The memo is reviewed and forwarded before the CEO decides (Part 7). Department budgets are approved first and shown when the CEO decides (Parts 3 and 8). DSA now has one rate per job scale wherever the activity is, plus KES 4,000 for casuals and attachees (INTERN). The HR staff list can be imported (Part 2). The CEO can instruct Finance and Procurement (Parts 8 to 10). Officers on an approved activity are blocked from overlapping ones (Part 11). The department submits its own report with the amounts spent (Part 13). Parts and checks marked **NEW** cover these.

Who takes part

FAPM is the Office of the CEO's confidential record of field activities. It is marked RESTRICTED: never show its screens or printouts to anyone outside the practice. Your trainer creates one test account for each role below. If one person is practising alone, sign in as each role in turn when a part says so. Sign out first each time (your name, top right, then **Sign out**).

Role	What they do in this practice
System Administrator	Imports the practice staff list and checks the Finance and Procurement settings.
Chief of Staff	Prepares the department budget, confirms the activity started, accepts the report and closes the activity.
Chief Executive Officer	Approves the budget and the memo, instructs Finance and Procurement, and looks at the results.
Assistant Chief of Staff	Reviews the memo, returns it once for correction, forwards it to the CEO and records attendance.
Head of Monitoring & Evaluation	Prepares the memo, builds the team and costs, corrects and resubmits it, and submits the activity report.
Head of Financial Services - Accounts	Receives the CEO's instruction to process the imprest and records the imprest number.
Head of Supply Chain	Receives the CEO's instruction to procure the travel tickets and records the ticket or LPO numbers.

For the trainer: create the Heads with `php artisan activities:create-user hod email "Name" --department="Monitoring & Evaluation"` (likewise "Financial Services - Accounts" and "Supply Chain"), and the other roles with `ceo`, `chief_of_staff`, `assistant_chief_of_staff` and `admin`.

Before you begin

- Your sign-in details for each role you will play, from your trainer.
- The practice staff list, **FAPM-Practice-Staff-List.xlsx**, kept beside this guide in `docs/guides`. Its eight officers are made up for practice; none is a real member of staff.
- A small PDF on your computer, any letter will do. You will attach it as the activity report.
- Your phone, only if the system asks for a six-digit code when you sign in.

The practice activity

Field on the screen	What to type or choose
Title	Monitoring visit, Kisumu Central
Category, then Activity type	Monitoring & Evaluation, then Monitoring visit
Purpose (objective)	Check progress of ongoing NG-CDF projects in Kisumu Central
Expected outcomes and deliverables	A site report on each project visited
Participants and stakeholders	Four M&E officers; the constituency committee
Introduction and justification	The quarterly monitoring plan schedules Kisumu Central this month.
Key risks to be mitigated	Heavy rain may delay site visits.
Planned start, Number of days	Today's date, 3 (the end date becomes the day after tomorrow, 2 nights)
County, Constituency, Venue	Kisumu, Kisumu Central, NG-CDF Kisumu Central office
Budget line	ME-01 Field monitoring (you create it in Part 3)
Estimated budget (KES)	77000
Team	Peter Otieno (Team lead), Amina Hassan, Faith Wanjiku and Brian Kiptoo (Members)
Other costs	Travel: air ticket for Peter Otieno, 18,000.00. Board vehicle fuel, whole activity, 8,000.00

The figures you should see

Cost line	How it is worked out	KES
DSA, Peter Otieno (scale 6)	2 nights × 11,200	22,400.00
DSA, Amina Hassan (scale 9)	2 nights × 6,300	12,600.00
DSA, Faith Wanjiku (casual, INTERN)	2 nights × 4,000	8,000.00
DSA, Brian Kiptoo (attachee, INTERN)	2 nights × 4,000	8,000.00
Travel, air ticket, Peter Otieno	Typed in	18,000.00
Board vehicle fuel	Typed in	8,000.00
Total		**77,000.00**

Words you will see

Word	Meaning
Activity memo	A department's request to carry out an activity. The system writes the memo document from what you enter.
Draft	Saved but not yet sent. Only the department can see it, and anything can still change.
Under review	With the Assistant Chief of Staff or Chief of Staff, who either forward it or return it.
Returned for correction	Sent back to the Head of Department with a note saying what to fix.
Awaiting decision	With the CEO. Forwarding is never an approval.
Approved, Declined	The CEO's answer. Declined is final.
Instruction	The CEO's request to Finance (process the imprest) or Procurement (procure the travel tickets) on an approved activity.
In progress, Completed	The team is in the field; the team is back and the report is due.
Report received, Closed	The Office of the CEO accepted the report; the activity is finished and read only.
DSA, job scale, INTERN	Daily Subsistence Allowance. One rate per job scale (1 to 10) from the HR register, the same for every destination. Casuals and attachees without a scale are INTERN, KES 4,000.
Budget position	A department's allocation for the year, what is spent, committed and pending, and the balance.

Part 1: Sign in

EVERY ROLE, THE FIRST TIME

1. Open the web address your trainer gave you and type your email and password, then press **Sign in**.
2. The first time only, the NG-CDF Board Data Privacy Statement appears. Read it, tick the box to agree, and accept.
3. If asked for a code, type the six digits your authenticator app shows.
4. The menu on the left takes you everywhere. Each role sees only its own menu items.

> **Check.** The Heads of Department see **Activity memos** and **Staff list**, but no Dashboard, Activity register, Calendar or Reports. The System Administrator sees settings, users, the staff list and the audit log, but no activities.

Part 2: Load the staff list NEW

SIGN IN AS THE SYSTEM ADMINISTRATOR

1. Click **Staff list**, then **Import HR list**. Choose **FAPM-Practice-Staff-List.xlsx**.
2. Press **Check file**. It says 8 officers would be added and saves nothing yet.
3. Press **Import**. The eight officers appear in the list.
4. Click **Reference data**, then the **Thresholds** tab. Find **Finance department (imprest instructions)** and **Procurement department (ticket instructions)**. Leave both on "(default)", which means Financial Services - Accounts and Supply Chain.

> **Check.** Faith Wanjiku (casual) and Brian Kiptoo (attachee) have job grade **INTERN**, although their grade was blank in the file. The permanent officers show the scale from the file, for example Peter Otieno 6. Import the same file again: it says 0 added and 8 updated, and no one is duplicated.

> **Test a mistake.** In a copy of the file, change one Department to "Accounts" and press **Check file**. Nothing is imported, and the error message gives that row's number.

Part 3: Approve the department's budget NEW

SIGN IN AS THE CHIEF OF STAFF, THEN AS THE CEO

1. As the Chief of Staff, click **Department budgets**, then **Prepare a budget**. Choose Monitoring & Evaluation and FY 2026/27, then press **Create draft**.
2. Press **Add line**: code **ME-01**, name **Field monitoring**, allocation **500000**. Save the line.
3. Press **Submit to the CEO** and confirm. Sign out.
4. As the CEO, open **Department budgets**, open the Monitoring & Evaluation budget and press **Approve budget**. Sign out.

Check. Before the CEO approves, the budget counts for nothing. After approval, **Budget position** shows Monitoring & Evaluation with an allocation of KES 500,000.00 and the full amount available.

Part 4: Prepare the memo NEW

SIGN IN AS THE HEAD OF MONITORING & EVALUATION

1. Click **Activity memos**, then **Create new activity memo**.
2. Fill in the form from the practice table: title, category, activity type, purpose, expected outcomes, participants, introduction and justification, and key risks.
3. Choose today as the **Planned start** and type 3 in **Number of days**. The end date and "2 nights" fill in by themselves.
4. Choose the county Kisumu, the constituency Kisumu Central, and type the venue.
5. Under **Costing**, choose the budget line ME-01 Field monitoring and type 77000 as the estimated budget. The department's allocation, spent, committed and available balance appear beside it.
6. Press **Save draft**. The memo page opens with its reference number and the status Draft.

Check. The board shows the memo under Drafts. The page says only your department can see it. Sign in as another Head of Department, for example Supply Chain: the memo is not on their board.

Part 5: Build the team and costs NEW

STILL THE HEAD OF MONITORING & EVALUATION

1. On the memo page press **Team and costs**, then **Add officers**.
2. Type Otieno in the search box and tick Peter Otieno. Choose Team lead in the role box and press **Add to team**.
3. Press **Add officers** again, clear the search and choose Monitoring & Evaluation in the department filter. Press **Select all shown**: Amina, Faith and Brian are ticked. Choose Member as the role and press **Add to team**.
4. Under Planned costs, check the four DSA lines against the figures table. You do not type DSA.
5. Press **Add cost line**: category Travel, for Peter Otieno, travel mode Air, description "Air ticket Nairobi to Kisumu", amount 18,000.00. Save.
6. Add another: Board vehicle fuel, for the whole activity, 8,000.00. Save, then press **Back to the memo**.

Check. The total is KES 77,000.00. The DSA is the same rate per scale wherever the activity is. Faith and Brian get KES 4,000 a night as INTERN. In step 3 Peter was not in the list, because officers already on the team are not offered again.

Part 6: Preview and submit for review

STILL THE HEAD OF MONITORING & EVALUATION

1. Press **Preview memo**. The system writes the memo in the Board's format, with Annex A (budget breakdown), Annex B (detailed budget, with scale, days and rates) and Annex C (participant itinerary).
2. Check that the names, dates and the total of KES 77,000.00 are the same in the memo and its annexes. The document uses the Gill Sans MT font if it is installed on the server, and DejaVu Sans if not.
3. Press **Submit for review**. Under **Send it to** choose Assistant Chief of Staff, and confirm. Sign out.

Check. The status becomes Under review and the memo can no longer be edited. The Assistant Chief of Staff gets an alert in the bell at the top right.

Test the blockers. Before step 3 on a second draft, leave the team empty. Submit is refused, and the box on the memo page lists in red what is missing.

Part 7: Review, return and forward NEW

ASSISTANT CHIEF OF STAFF, THEN HEAD OF MONITORING & EVALUATION, THEN ASSISTANT AGAIN

1. As the Assistant, click **Activity memos** and open the memo. Read it with **Memo and annexes**.
2. Press **Return for correction** and type "Add the programme of the visit." Confirm and sign out.
3. As the Head of M&E, open the memo from **Returned for correction**. The note is shown in orange. Press **Edit memo**. Under **More memo sections** press **Add a section**, with heading "Programme of the visit" and a line of text. Save.
4. Press **Resubmit for review**. It goes back to the Assistant. Sign out.
5. As the Assistant, open the memo again and press **Forward to CEO**, with a recommendation if you wish. Sign out.

Check. The memo now shows the new section after Key risks. The status is Awaiting decision. The review comments are kept as written and cannot be edited.

Part 8: The CEO approves and instructs Finance and Procurement NEW

SIGN IN AS THE CEO

1. Click **Decision queue**. The memo is listed with its dates, team, cost and a Late notice label, since it starts today. Press **Memo and annexes** to read it.
2. Press **Open** to go to the activity page, then **Approve and authorise**.
3. The popup shows the Monitoring & Evaluation budget position: allocation 500,000.00, available balance, and the balance if approved, 423,000.00.
4. Under **Instruct the departments that act on the approval**, tick **Finance: process the imprest** and **Procurement: procure the travel tickets**. In **Note to them** type "Economy class; imprest to the team lead".
5. Press **Approve and authorise**. Sign out.

Check. The status is Approved. The Head of M&E, the Chief of Staff and the Assistant are alerted about the approval. On the activity's **Decisions & directives** tab, the **Finance and Procurement** panel lists both instructions as Sent. Only the Heads of Financial Services - Accounts and Supply Chain get an instruction alert; the Head of M&E does not.

Also try. You can approve without ticking anything and instruct later. Press **Instruct** in the Finance and Procurement panel. A kind that was already sent is greyed out with "Already instructed". As the Chief of Staff, the Instruct button does not appear: only the CEO sends instructions.

Part 9: Finance processes the imprest NEW

SIGN IN AS THE HEAD OF FINANCIAL SERVICES - ACCOUNTS

1. The bell shows the new instruction, and the menu has **Instructions** with a count of 1. Click it.
2. Open the instruction. The sheet shows the CEO's note, the activity's reference, dates and places, the team with PF numbers and scales, and every planned cost line.
3. Press **Acknowledge**. The status becomes Acknowledged.
4. Press **Mark as done**. Type **IMP/PRAC/001** as the **Imprest number** and press **Done**. Sign out.

> **Check.** The sheet has no justification, review comments, documents or budget position, and no link to the memo. Pressing **Done** with the imprest number empty is refused. The instruction moves to the **Completed** tab.

Part 10: Procurement buys the tickets NEW

SIGN IN AS THE HEAD OF SUPPLY CHAIN, THEN AS THE CEO

1. Click **Instructions** and open the instruction to procure the travel tickets.
2. Under **Travel and transport costs**, only the air ticket for Peter Otieno (18,000.00) is listed.
3. Press **Mark as done** without acknowledging first. Type **LPO/PRAC/001** as the **LPO or ticket numbers** and press **Done**. Sign out.
4. As the CEO, look at the bell: two alerts say Finance and Procurement have completed their instructions. On the activity's **Decisions & directives** tab, both show Completed with their references.

> **Check.** Procurement never sees the DSA lines or the fuel line. The Chief of Staff, the Assistant and the Head of M&E are also alerted when an instruction is completed. A Head of any other department, for example ICT, has no Instructions menu.

Part 11: Check availability NEW

SIGN IN AS THE HEAD OF MONITORING & EVALUATION

1. Create a second memo, "Availability test", starting tomorrow for 1 day, in any county. Save it as a draft.
2. Press **Team and costs**, then **Add officers**, and search for Peter Otieno.
3. Peter cannot be ticked: he is on another approved activity on that day. The message does not say which activity.
4. Press **Discard draft** on the memo page to remove the test memo.

> **Check.** A Head of Department cannot override the block. Only the Office of the CEO can recall or release an officer, from the activity's Team tab, and must give a reason. Any officer on a memo that is only pending shows a warning, not a block.

Part 12: The team sets off and comes back

CHIEF OF STAFF, THEN ASSISTANT CHIEF OF STAFF

1. As the Chief of Staff, open the activity from the **Activity register** and press **Confirm commencement**. The status becomes In progress. On the live system the daily check also starts approved activities on their start date by itself.
2. Click **In the field today**. The four officers are listed with Kisumu Central and their return date. Sign out.
3. As the Assistant, open the activity's **Team** tab. Set Peter, Amina and Faith to Attended, and Brian Kiptoo to Did not attend.
4. Press **Mark completed** and confirm, leaving the date empty to use the planned end date. The status becomes Completed. Sign out.

> **Check.** The activity page says the report is due 7 working days after the end date.

Part 13: The department submits its report NEW

SIGN IN AS THE HEAD OF MONITORING & EVALUATION

1. Open the memo from **Activity memos** and press **Submit activity report**.
2. Type what the activity achieved, a key finding and a recommendation, and attach your PDF as the report document.
3. Under **Actually spent on each cost line**, type the planned amount on every line except Brian Kiptoo's DSA: type 0 there, since he did not travel.
4. Press **Submit report**. Sign out.

> **Check.** Leaving one amount empty is refused: enter 0 where nothing was spent. After submitting, **Budget position** shows 69,000.00 as spent for Monitoring & Evaluation (77,000 less Brian's 8,000).

Part 14: Accept the report and close

SIGN IN AS THE CHIEF OF STAFF

1. Open the activity. Press **Return report** and type "Add the number of projects visited." Confirm. Sign in as the Head of M&E, press **Correct and resubmit the report**, change the text and submit again. Sign in as the Chief of Staff again.
2. Press **Accept report**. The status becomes Report received. The **Report** tab shows what was achieved beside what was expected.
3. Press **Close** and confirm. The status becomes Closed, and nothing on the activity can be changed any more.

> **Check.** If **Close** is refused, the message says what is missing: the report, attendance for someone, or an actual amount on a cost line.

Part 15: Look around

SIGN IN AS THE CEO

Menu item	What you will see
Dashboard	Activities in each stage, late notice, overdue reports and cost. Click any number to see the activities behind it.
Activity memos	Every department's memos by stage, with the memo report.
Budget position	Each department's allocation, spent, committed, pending and balance for the year. Exports to Excel and PDF.
Staff participation	Each officer's field days and costs. Search for Peter Otieno.
Reports	Open one and press PDF, Excel or Print. Every copy carries RESTRICTED, your name and the time, in Gill Sans MT where it is installed.
Audit and access log	As the System Administrator: every view of the activity, including the instruction sheets Finance and Procurement opened.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
A red message under a box	That box is required or the value is not allowed. Correct it and save again.
A red message at the top right	The system refused the step and says why. Do what it says.
"No DSA rate was found"	The officer has no job grade. Ask the System Administrator to correct it in the Staff list.
The CEO's popup has no instruction boxes	The department is not set, or the instruction was already sent. Check Reference data › Thresholds.
"has no active Head of Department yet"	The instruction was saved but nobody can act on it. Create that department's Head account; it then appears in their Instructions.
A button you expected is missing	Your role does not do that step, or the activity is in a different stage. Check which role the part names.
Back on the sign-in page	You were signed out after 15 minutes without activity. Sign in again.
Something else	Write down the reference number, the role you were signed in as, what you pressed and the exact message, and tell your trainer. Do not send screenshots outside the team.

You have finished when

- The practice activity shows Closed, and its budget position shows 69,000.00 spent.
- Both instructions show Completed with IMP/PRAC/001 and LPO/PRAC/001.
- Every **Check** box in this guide behaved as described. Report any that did not to your trainer, with the part number.

When you are comfortable, your trainer will give you your account on the live system. From then on, real memos come from the Heads of Department and follow the same path.